A Comparison between the Eastern and Western Portraits of Man in Our Time

There is a level deep within man where there is no difference at all in humanity between a man from the East or the West, the North or the South. This is an elemental, natural, primary, and basic human level. The need for comfort, food, housing, satisfactions of the emotional needs of affection, a feeling of security, love, and sex are common to humanity as such. Affectionate regard from family and friends around, capacities for nobler and higher loyalties and devotion, and gratefulness are deep down common to the majority of all people regardless of their geographical differences. Human infants and children of all different races and geographically different locations are all alike. They are all just human infants, so is the love of the mothers for their infants. As a poet said, a man's a man for all that. Does man not laugh when you tickle him? Does he not bleed when you cut him? Is not one man hurt or pleased as another is?

There are, however, differences between men, but the point to be made is that these differences are adult-conditioned and artificial in the sense that they are the products of education, and political, economic, religious, social, and cultural training. They are adult-made and can be remolded and changed if man wanted to, that is to say, if man was prepared to rise above his present national, patriotic, and racial levels of existence regardless of his national likes, dislikes, and prejudices, he could realize the unity of man all around. What then are the differences, nurtured and educated between man and man? What are the differences today in the two portraits of man—the Eastern and the Western?

To begin with my portrait of a Western man, it must be remembered that I am an Indian, an Easterner, and also an individual with my own reflections. No claim, therefore, to absolute objectivity or truth is to be attributed to what are only my own